



Dak Guru

A Self Learning Portal

Postal Manual Vol – VI – PART - I

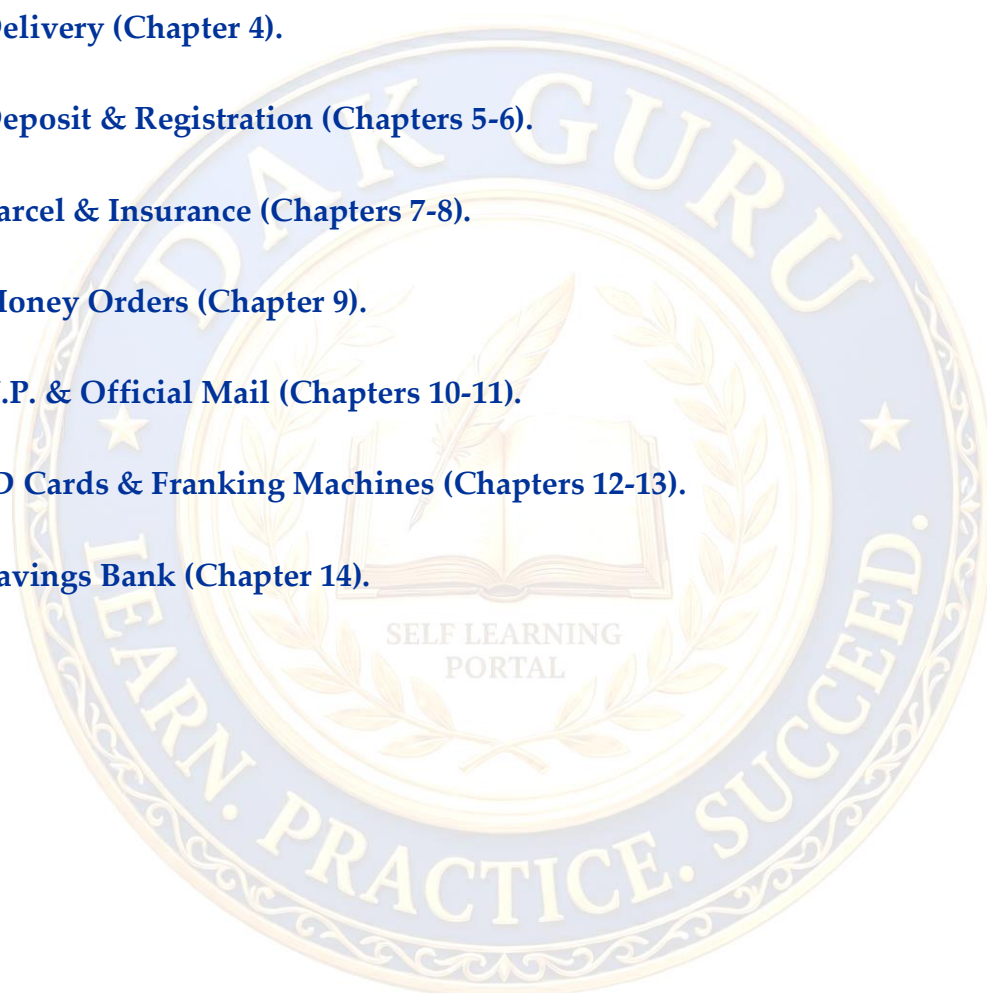
(as per recent amendments/changes upto 31.12.2025)

DISCLAIMER: *This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and the inclusion of recent changes, amendments, and updates to the relevant Acts, Rules, and Regulations, this document is intended as a study aid only. Readers and students are strongly recommended to refer to official government sources or gazettes for the most reliable and authoritative information.*

Postal Manual Volume VI

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Chapter 1: Miscellaneous Rules

Rule 1. No gratuities to be taken by official

(1) The Postmaster should see that where this can be done without interfering with the work of the office, the official assist illiterate persons in filling up money order forms, etc., but he must strictly enforce the rule prohibiting the acceptance of any fee or gratuity for this work.

(2) If professional letter-writers are allowed to work on the premises, the Postmaster should see that their charges are in accordance with the prescribed scale of fees, and any attempt at extortion should be reported to the Superintendent. Approved candidates and relatives of clerks must on no account be allowed to work as professional letter-writers.

Rule 2. Work on Sundays and Post Office holidays

(1) Savings Bank transactions, payment of money orders and telegraphic money orders and delivery of ordinary mail will not be carried out on Sundays and Post Office holidays, but all other work will be carried out as on other days of the week.

(2) As an exception to **Rule 2** above, these post offices will prepare the daily H.O. or Sub-office accounts for the transactions on Sundays also as usual.



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Post Office Regulations, 2024 (Notification No. S.O. 5440(E), dated 16th December 2024)

Regulation 5. Business Hours:

(1) The Circle Head, Regional Head and Divisional Head are empowered to specify the period of each of the post offices under their jurisdiction, during which business is transacted with the public or customer...

(2) The Circle Head or Regional Head may... specify (a) the business hours and the days other than the working days including Sundays and holidays, during which the post offices shall be opened for business.

Rule 2/1. Night Post Offices

(1) The working hours of the post offices are generally fixed by the Head of the Circle according to the timings given in **Clause 1** of the Post Office Guide. However, the Director-General may extend the

working hours of any post office up to **8:30 P.M.** and keep them open on Sundays also. These post offices will be termed 'Night Post Offices' and will transact those transactions which have been authorised by the Director-General in this behalf.

(2) Work to be done in extended time:

Service	Transaction Limit / Details
Registry items	Including V.P. Items will be booked.
Money Orders	T.M.O. will be issued.
Stamps/IPO	I.P.O., National Savings Certificate and postal stamps will be sold.
Savings Bank	Related work till 7:30 P.M.
Payments	Wire money payment of orders by 6:00 P.M.

Rule 3. Departments of a Post Office

(1) The work of a large post office is divided into the following departments:

- **Mails**
- **Sorting**
- **Delivery**
- **Deposits**
- **Registration**
- **Parcels**
- **Money Orders**
- **Cash**
- **Sub-Account**

Rule 4. Memorandum of Distribution of Work

- (1) The Postmaster must maintain a **Memorandum of Distribution of Work** (Form **Ms-11**) showing the duties assigned to each official in the office. This memorandum must be kept up to date and signed by the Postmaster.
- (2) In Head Offices and large Sub-Offices, the nominal roll of Postal Assistants actually at work in a post office on any given day is maintained in Form **Ms-12**.



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Post Office Regulations, 2024 (Notification No. S.O. 5440(E))

Regulation 3. Definitions:

- (k) "Post" means any system for collection, clearance, sorting, dispatch, conveyance, and delivery of items by the postal network.

Rule 4-A. Attendance Register

- (1) An attendance register in Form **S-37** will be maintained in every post office having more than one clerk.

Rule 5. Village Sorting List

- (1) A Village Sorting List in Form **M-52** will be prepared and supplied to each office by the **Sub-Divisional Inspector**.
- (2) The list will contain the names of all villages served by the office and the days on which they are served.
- (3) A Route List in Form **M-53** is issued by the **Sub-Divisional Inspector** to the Village Postman.

Rule 6. Yearly Village Return

- (1) The yearly village return (**Ms-88**) in the month of **February** of each year should be kept by the **Sub-Account Assistant**, showing the number of articles of all sorts received for delivery in each village within the jurisdiction of the office.

(2) As soon as the compilation is over, it should be totalled, signed by the **Postmaster** and forwarded to the **Sub-Divisional Inspector**.

Rule 9. Receipts to be taken from addressees

(1) Receipts are to be taken from addressees of redirected articles in certain cases where the article has been opened or damaged.

Rule 10. Assessment of Customs Duty

(1) The assessment of customs duty on inward foreign articles is the duty of the Customs Authorities, but the realization of the duty is the duty of the Post Office.

(2) The Postmaster must ensure that the duty assessed is recovered before the article is delivered.

Rule 17. Payments in cash and notes

(1) Payments may be made in cash, currency notes or silver. The public have no right to demand change for currency notes or silver.

(2) **Admittance of strangers:** Strangers must not be admitted inside the Post Office work-area. The Postmaster must see that this rule is strictly enforced.

(3) Any information received by the officer of the Department officially should not be made public. This restriction is, however, not applicable to:

- Competent Court of Law
 - District Magistrate
 - Commissioner of Police or District Superintendent of Police
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Rule 21. Custody of blank forms

(1) The Postmaster is responsible for the safe custody of blank forms, especially Money Order forms and other accountable forms.

(2) **MO Oblong Stamp** and **Insurance Stamp** should be kept in the custody of the **Postmaster**.

Rule 25. Disposal of Records

(1) Records must be preserved for the periods prescribed in the Manual.

(2) Preservation Periods:

Record Name	Preservation Period
Nominal Roll	Permanent
Stock Book	10 Years
Order Book	Permanent

(3) The following records may **not** be destroyed without the special permission of the **Head of the Circle**:

- Post Office Order Book.
- Register of undeliverable passbooks in deposit in the Head Office.
- Correspondence regarding which enquiry is in progress or connected with cases which have not been fully decided.

Rule 27. Remittances

(1) **Leather Cash Bag** should be used when the amount of currency notes exceeds **Rs. 500**.

(2) When a remittance is to be sent by post, the money should be placed in a leather cash bag and cash sealed by the Treasurer.

Rule 32/1. Identification Cards

(1) The loss of an identity card should immediately be notified by the **Head of the Circle** in his circular.

Rule 32/2. Business Reply Cards

(1) The annual fee of business reply cards should be realized in advance and credited to **UCR** (Unclassified Receipts).

Chapter 2: Mail Department

Rule 57. Clearance of Letter Boxes

- (1) The hours of clearance of letter boxes should be so fixed that the mails will reach the post office in time for the dispatch for which they are intended.
- (2) **Movable Plates:** Letter boxes fixed in walls or pillars should be provided with movable plates showing the hours of clearance.
- (3) **Procedure:** The official clearing the letter box should verify that the lock is in good order, and if any defect is noticed, it should be reported immediately to the Postmaster. He should then unlock the box, empty the contents into his bag, and lock the box again.
- (4) **Letter Box Peons:** Letter box peons must be provided with a badge and a time-piece (watch). They are not allowed to distribute letters or perform other duties while on their clearance rounds.



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Rationalization of Mail Products (OM No. Mail-30/5/2025-D-DOP, dated 8th August 2025)

Subject: Discontinuation of Registered Post

Effective Date: 01.10.2025

- (a) Speed Post (Letter and Parcel) shall henceforth be the basic mail service for address-specific delivery of accountable postal items in the country.
- (b) Registration will be available as a value-added service for Speed Post items only.
- (c) Any document, receipt, or form currently mentioning 'Registered Post' will be revised to refer exclusively to 'Speed Post'.

Rule 60. Facing

- (1) The articles cleared from letter boxes should be brought to the facing table.
- (2) **Facing** means the arrangement of articles with the address side upwards and the addresses turned in the same direction.
- (3) While facing, the articles should be divided into two classes:
 - Articles of the **Letter Mail** (Letters, Postcards, and Letter Cards).

- Articles of the **Packet Mail** (Book packets, Pattern packets, and Registered Newspapers).

Rule 61. Stamping

(1) All postage stamps on the articles must be defaced with the date-stamp. The object of defacing postage stamps is to prevent them from being used again.

(2) If a postage stamp has escaped defacement at the office of posting, it must be defaced at the office of delivery or at any intermediate office where the irregularity is noticed.¹

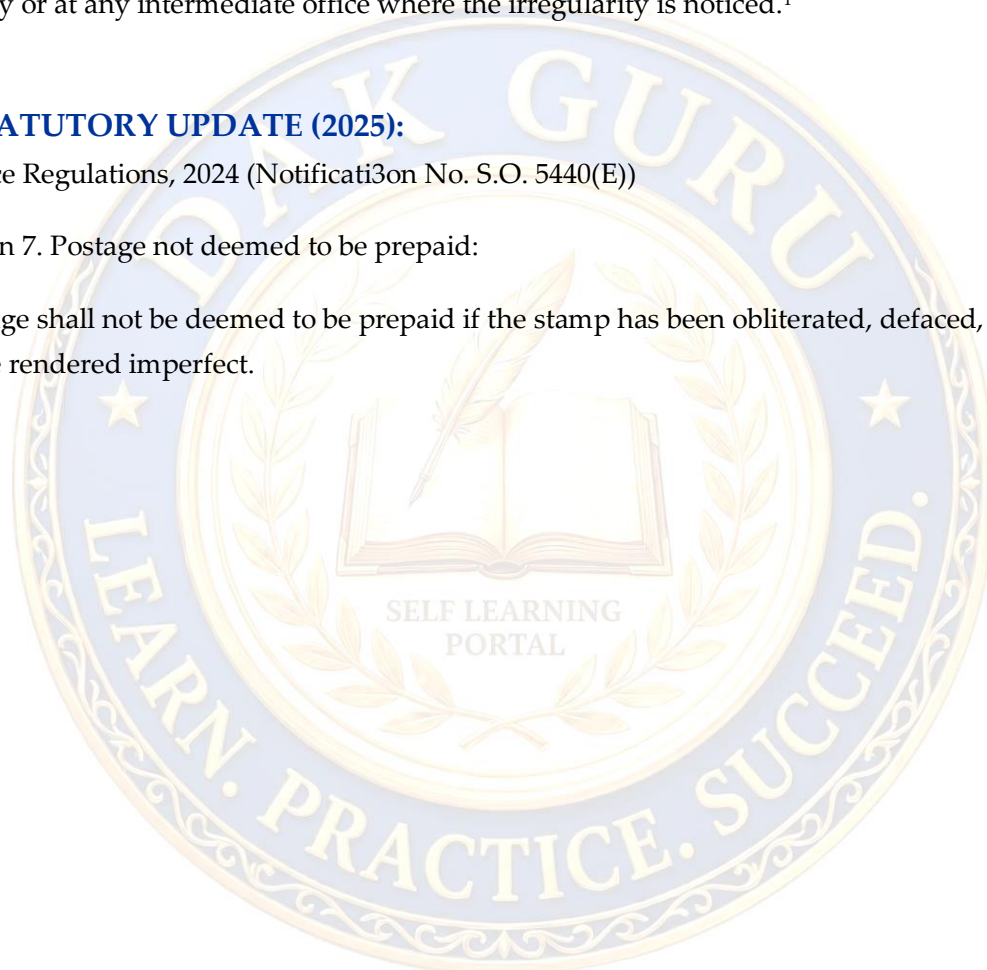


STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Post Office Regulations, 2024 (Notification No. S.O. 5440(E))

Regulation 7. Postage not deemed to be prepaid:

The postage shall not be deemed to be prepaid if the stamp has been obliterated, defaced, torn, cut or otherwise rendered imperfect.



Chapter 3: Sorting Department

Rule 64. Station Bundles

- (1) When the number of articles of the letter mail (excluding registered articles) for any post office or mail office exceeds **14**, they should be formed into a separate bundle called a **Station Bundle**.
 - (2) This bundle should be tied with a check-slip (Form **M-7**) facing outwards.
 - (3) **Territorial Bundles:** When the number of articles for a State or Territory is sufficient to form a bundle (but not enough for a station bundle for a single office), a **Territorial Bundle** may be prepared.
 - (4) Articles for which no station or territorial bundle can be formed are termed "**Unsorted**" and should be disposed of in the Sorting Case.
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Rule 65. Direct Mail Bags

- (1) A **Direct Mail Bag** is a bag closed by a post office or mail office for another post office or mail office with which it is not in direct communication.
- (2) **Criteria:** A direct mail bag should be closed when the number of articles (letters, postcards, etc.) for a particular office exceeds **200** or when the articles are bulky enough to fill a bag.
- (3) **Label:** The label of a direct mail bag must bear the letter '**D**' to distinguish it from an ordinary account bag or sorting bag.
- (4) Direct mail bags should not contain registered articles or money orders unless specifically authorized.



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Post Office (Second Amendment) Regulations, 2025 (Notification G.S.R. 263(E), dated 28th March 2025)

Regulation 92A. GYAN POST:

(1) A new category termed "Gyan Post" is introduced for books/packets containing syllabus books from recognized boards/universities.

(2) Conditions:

- Must bear inscription "**Gyan Post**" on the outside.

- Must NOT contain advertisements (except book lists).
- **Mode:** Transmitted by **Surface Mode** only.
- Tracking: transmitted as a Trackable Item.

(3) Rates: As per Table X of Schedule I.

Rule 83. Sorting Cases

(1) The sorting case is divided into pigeon-holes, each labeled with the name of a post office, mail office, or section.

(2) The labels are arranged geographically to facilitate sorting.

(3) **Selection of Sorting Case:** The Postmaster must ensure that the sorting case used corresponds to the sorting list supplied by the Superintendent.

(4) **Examination:** The sorting case must be examined daily to ensure that no article is left in the pigeon-holes after the dispatch of mails.

Rule 85. Missent Articles

(1) **Missent articles** are articles which have been erroneously forwarded to an office other than the office of destination or the proper office of transit.

(2) Such articles must be stamped with the "**Missent**" stamp and forwarded to their correct destination by the first available mail.

(3) A report of missent articles must be made to the Superintendent in the prescribed form (**Ms-14** - Error Book).

Chapter 4: Delivery of Mails

Rule 98. Limitation of Delivery

- (1) The delivery of articles is limited to the hours fixed for the purpose by the Head of the Circle.
- (2) No person living within the limits of the post town is entitled to receive his letters at the window of the post office unless he rents a **Post Box** or unless the article is one which cannot be delivered through the postmen.



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Post Office (Fourth Amendment) Regulations, 2025 (Notification S.O. 4375(E), dated 25th September 2025)

Regulation 22A. OTP Based Delivery:

- (1) A value-added service of One-Time Password (OTP) Delivery is available for Speed Post items (Documents and Parcels).
- (2) Fee: Rs. 5/- (GST extra) per item.
- (3) Procedure: The item shall be handed over to the addressee only upon successful confirmation of the OTP shared with the delivery staff.

Rule 113. Window Delivery

(1) "Window Delivery" means the delivery of articles at the window of the post office to the addressees or their authorized agents.

(2) **Articles for Window Delivery:** The following classes of articles are delivered at the window:

- Articles addressed to "Poste Restante" or "To await arrival."
- Articles bearing the superscription "To be kept till called for."
- Articles for persons who have rented a **Post Box**.
- Insured articles, V.P. articles, and Money Orders exceeding the limit entrusted to a postman.

(3) **Identification:** The Postmaster must satisfy himself as to the identity of the person applying for delivery. If the person is not known to the Postmaster, he must be identified by some person known to the Postmaster or must produce satisfying evidence of his identity.

Rule 114. Delivery of Registered Articles

- (1) Registered articles must be delivered to the addressee or his authorized agent.
- (2) **Receipt:** No registered article may be delivered unless the addressee or his agent signs the receipt and the acknowledgment (if any).

**STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):**

Post Office Regulations, 2024 (Notification No. S.O. 5440(E))

Regulation 18. Delivery of Registered Mail:

- (a) Addressee Specific Delivery: If the sender has opted for "Addressee Specific Delivery" (Fee: Rs. 5/- + GST), the article shall be delivered exclusively to the addressee or a person duly authorized by the addressee.
- (b) Address Specific Delivery: In other cases, delivery may be made to any adult member of the family at the address, provided the addressee has not lodged a specific objection.

Rule 115. Post Boxes

(1) The system of Post Boxes is intended to facilitate the delivery of mails to regular recipients who desire to obtain their letters at the earliest possible moment.

(2) Conditions:

- A Post Box can be rented at any post office where the system is in force.
- The renter is supplied with a key.
- Articles addressed to the Post Box number are placed in the box.

(3) **Clearance:** The renter or his messenger may clear the box at any time during the business hours of the office.

(4) Prescribed Rents:

Period	Rent (Historic/Manual Rate)
Full Financial Year (April-March)	Rs. 150
Three Calendar Months	Rs. 50

**STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):****Post Office Regulations, 2024 (Regulation 46 & 47)**

Condition (c)(i): Where any item addressed to a post box number cannot, in view of its size or nature (e.g., Parcels, Registered Articles), be placed in the box, an intimation slip shall be placed in the box.

Condition (d): The Postmaster may withdraw the Post Box facility if the renter fails to clear the box for a period of 7 days despite notice.

Rule 120. Intimation of Arrival

(1) When a registered article, insured article, or value-payable article cannot be delivered by the postman (due to the addressee being absent or the amount being large), an **Intimation** in form **Rp-53** is to be delivered to the addressee.

(2) The article will be retained in the post office for a period of **7 days** (excluding the day of presentation).

(3) If the addressee fails to take delivery within this period, the article will be returned to the sender.

**STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):**

India Post Parcel Regulations, 2024 (Administrative Instructions)

Clause 4. Delivery of Parcels:

- **Digital Intimation:** For trackable items (Speed Post/Parcels), intimation may be sent via **SMS** to the mobile number provided.
- **Retention:** Undelivered parcels are retained for **7 days** after the first delivery attempt.
- **Extension:** Addressee may request retention for up to **7 additional days** with written instructions (Total **14 days**).

Rule 134. Refusal of Articles

(1) If the addressee refuses to accept an article, it should be marked "**Refused**" and returned to the sender immediately.

(2) Official Syntax: The statement of the postman regarding refusal must be accepted as correct unless there is evidence to the contrary.

(3) Partial Refusal: An addressee cannot refuse to pay custom duty or other charges while accepting the article. He must either accept the article with all charges or refuse it entirely.



Chapter 5: Deposit Department

Rule 137. Articles addressed to deceased persons

- (1) An article addressed to a deceased person should be treated as **unclaimed** and disposed of accordingly, unless there is no doubt as to the title of the claimant to receive the article.
- (2) **Delivery to Claimant:** If the title is clear (e.g., near relative who has taken charge of the deceased's property), the Postmaster may deliver the article to such person on his granting a receipt and indemnifying the Post Office against any future claim.
- (3) **Dispute:** In case of any dispute or doubt, the article should be returned to the sender or the Returned Letter Office (RLO) with the remark "**Deceased**".
- (4) **Insured/V.P. Articles:** In the case of insured or value-payable articles found to be addressed to a deceased person, the Postmaster must not deliver them without the specific orders of the **Head of the Circle** or competent authority, unless the claimant produces a legal succession certificate.
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Rule 138. Detention of articles in the Post Office

- (1) **Ordinary Articles:** Articles of the letter mail (unregistered) which cannot be delivered should not be detained in the post office for more than **7 days**.
- (2) **Station Articles:** Articles addressed to the post town (Station Articles) which are unclaimed should be returned to the RLO after **7 days**.
- (3) **Exceptions:**
- Articles addressed to persons temporarily absent may be kept for a period not exceeding **7 days** provided the Postmaster has reason to believe they will return.
 - "Poste Restante" articles are kept for **one month**.

STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Post Office Regulations, 2024 (Regulation 43)

Retention Period:

The retention period for all categories of undeliverable mail (Registered, Parcel, Speed Post) where the addressee is not found is standardized to 7 days from the date of the last delivery attempt.

Note: If the addressee refuses the article, it must be returned immediately (no detention).

Chapter 6: Registration Department

Rule 156. General Rules (Registration)

(1) The registration of the following classes of articles is **compulsory**:

- Any parcel exceeding **4 kilograms** in weight.
- Any insured article.
- Any article containing a check, hundi, banknote, or postage stamps.
- Any article bearing the word "Registered" on the cover.

(2) **Fee:** The registration fee must be **prepaid** in addition to the postage.



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Rationalization of Mail Products (Notification No. Mail-30/5/2025-D-DOP)

Effective 01.09.2025: MERGER OF REGISTERED POST

- **Discontinuation:** The standalone "Registered Post" service is discontinued and merged into **Speed Post**.
- **New Status:** "Registration" is now a **feature** of Speed Post (Secure Transmission).
- **Documents:** Any rule in this Manual referring to "Registered Article" shall now apply mutatis mutandis to "**Speed Post (Documents)**".

Rule 163. Preparation of Registered Bundles

(1) When the number of registered articles for dispatch to any office or section exceeds **2**, they should be formed into a **Registered Bundle**.

(2) **Check List:** A Registered List (Form **Rp-32**) must be placed inside the bundle.

(3) **Tying:** The bundle must be tied with a **special knot** (Reef Knot) and sealed with the registration seal.

(4) **Blue Bag:** If the number of registered articles is large or bulky, they must be enclosed in a **Blue Registered Bag** (symbol 'R').

Rule 170. Compensation for loss or damage

(1) The Director-General may grant compensation to the sender of a registered article which has been lost or damaged in the course of transmission by post.

(2) Conditions:

- Application for compensation must be made within **3 months** of the date of posting.
- Compensation will not be paid if the loss is due to the fault or negligence of the sender (e.g., insecure packing).

(3) **Limit:** The compensation shall not exceed the limit prescribed by the Director-General.

(4) **Exclusions:** No compensation is payable for:

- Loss of currency notes (unless insured).
- Damage to fragile articles not properly packed.

**STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):**

Revised Compensation Policy (Lok Sabha Q. 2718 / Notification 2025)

Product	Compensation Limit (2025)
Speed Post (formerly Registered)	Double the Speed Post charges OR Rs. 1,000, whichever is less.
Registered Post (Legacy Claims)	Rs. 100 (for articles booked prior to merger).
International Registered	30 SDR (Special Drawing Rights).
Business Parcel	Rs. 500 or actual value (whichever is less).

Rule 174. Attestation of unknown delivery slips

(1) If a registered article is delivered to an illiterate addressee who cannot sign his name, his thumb impression or mark must be taken on the receipt and acknowledgment.

(2) **Attestation:** This mark must be attested by a respectable witness (other than the postman) who is personally known to the postman or the Postmaster.

Chapter 7: Parcel Department

Rule 179. Examination of Parcels

(1) Parcels received for dispatch should be examined to see that they are securely packed and that the conditions of posting have been complied with.

(2) **Packing:** If a parcel is not securely packed, or if it is not packed in accordance with the rules (e.g., containing liquids, sharp instruments), it should not be accepted for transmission.

(3) **Weight Check:** Every parcel must be weighed. If the weight exceeds the prescribed limit (**20 Kilograms** for ordinary/registered parcels), it must be returned to the sender.



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

India Post Parcel Network Policy (Notification No. P-11/2025-PNOP)

Clause 8. Standardization:

All parcels must conform to the standard dimensions compatible with the automated sorting centers.

- **Maximum Length: 1.5 meters**
- **Maximum Length + Girth: 3 meters**
- **Volumetric Weight:** For light but bulky parcels, postage shall be charged on the **Volumetric Weight** ($\text{Length} \times \text{Width} \times \text{Height} / 5000$).

Rule 185. Transmission of Parcels

(1) Parcels are transmitted by surface mail unless the sender has paid the fee for air transmission.

(2) **Registered Parcels:** Parcels weighing more than **4 kilograms** must be registered.

(3) **Handling:** Parcels must be handled with care. They should not be thrown or dragged.

Rule 193. Redirected Parcels

(1) A parcel which is redirected to any place served by the Inland Post is chargeable with a redirection fee.

(2) **Fee Calculation:** The redirection fee is **half the prepaid postage**.

(3) **Exemption:** No redirection fee is charged if the revised address is within the same delivery area or post town.

(4) **Refusal:** If the addressee refuses to pay the redirection fee, the parcel should not be delivered but treated as **refused**.

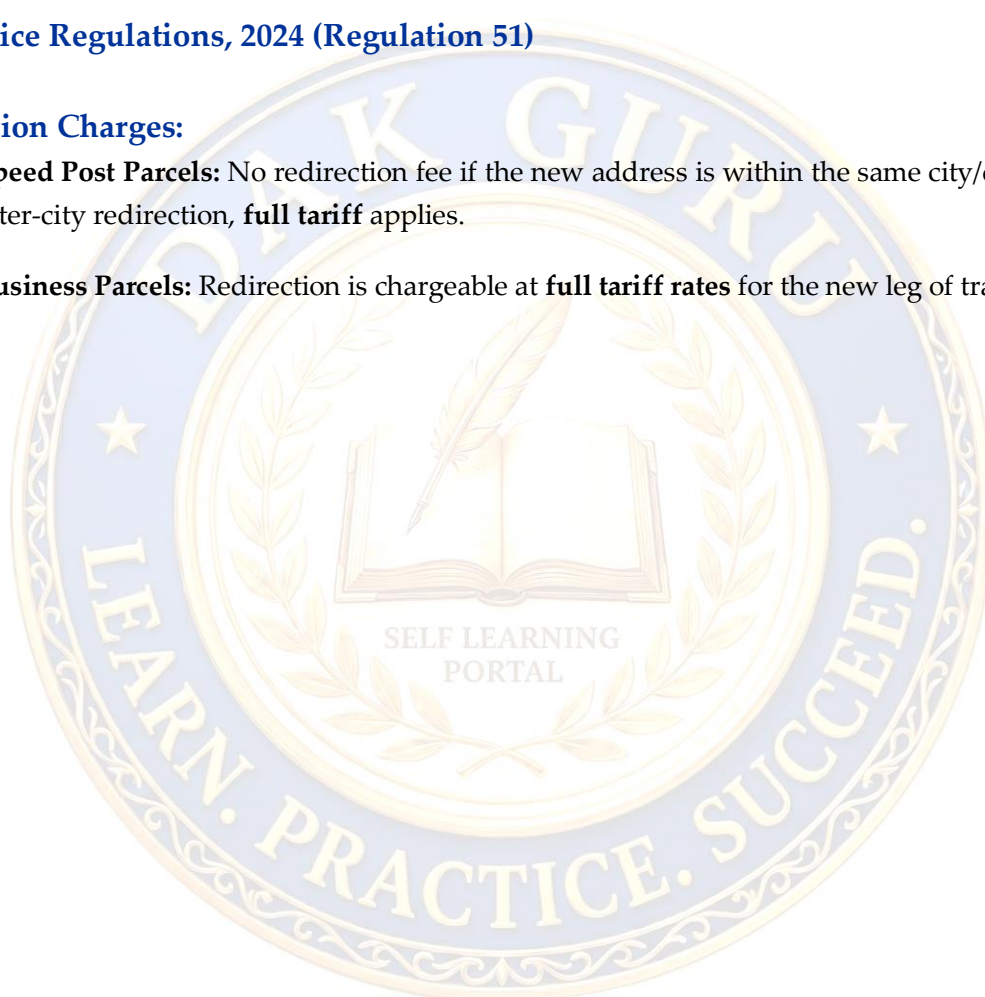


STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Post Office Regulations, 2024 (Regulation 51)

Redirection Charges:

- **Speed Post Parcels:** No redirection fee if the new address is within the same city/district. For inter-city redirection, **full tariff** applies.
- **Business Parcels:** Redirection is chargeable at **full tariff rates** for the new leg of transmission.



Chapter 8: Insured Articles

Rule 196. Responsibility of the Post Office

(1) The Post Office is responsible for the loss of the postal article or any of its contents or for any damage caused to it in the course of transmission by post, provided that the article has been insured and the prescribed insurance fee has been paid.

(2) **Exceptions:** The Post Office is **not** responsible:

- If the loss or damage is caused by the fault or negligence of the sender (e.g., defective packing).
- If the article contains prohibited goods.
- In cases of Force Majeure (e.g., earthquake, war).
- If the claim is not made within **3 months**.

Rule 200. Examination of Insured Articles (Conditions)

(1) Every article tendered for insurance must be examined to see that it is securely packed and sealed.

(2) **Seals:** The seals must be distinct and must be impressions of the **same private seal** of the sender.

- The device of the seal must not be that of a current coin or merely a series of straight, curved, or crossed lines.

(3) **Envelopes:** The envelope must be strong and not transparent. It must not have any black or colored border.

(4) **Weight and Value:** The weight in **grams** and the insured value in **words and figures** must be noted on the face of the article.



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Financial Services Division Notification (No. FS-10/2025-INS)

Updated Insurance Limits:

- **Maximum Insurance Limit:** Enhanced to **Rs. 10,00,000** (Ten Lakhs) for Speed Post articles at authorized Head Offices.
- **Branch Offices:** The limit for booking insured articles at Branch Post Offices remains **Rs. 600**.

- **Currency:** Transmission of Currency Notes by Insured Post is limited to **Rs. 20,000**.
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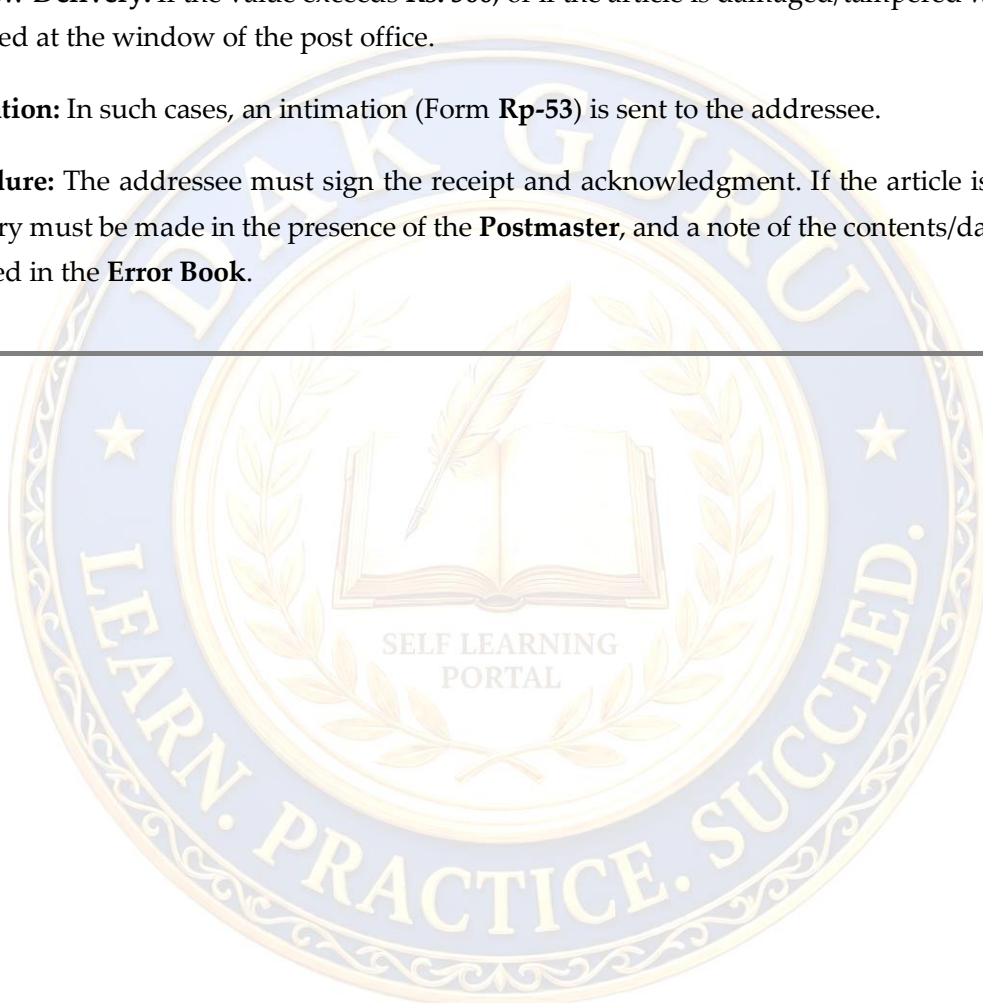
Rule 203. Delivery of Insured Articles

(1) **Limit for Postman:** An insured article may be delivered by the postman if the value insured does not exceed **Rs. 500**.

(2) **Window Delivery:** If the value exceeds **Rs. 500**, or if the article is damaged/tampered with, it must be delivered at the window of the post office.

(3) **Intimation:** In such cases, an intimation (Form **Rp-53**) is sent to the addressee.

(4) **Procedure:** The addressee must sign the receipt and acknowledgment. If the article is damaged, the delivery must be made in the presence of the **Postmaster**, and a note of the contents/damage must be recorded in the **Error Book**.



Chapter 9: Money Order Department

Rule 236. Issue of Money Orders

(1) **Form:** Money orders must be issued on the prescribed form (MO-8). The remitter must fill in the entries in ink.

(2) **Prohibitions:**

- No money order may contain any fractional part of a paisa.
- The amount for a single money order must not exceed **Rs. 5,000**.

(3) **Acknowledgment:** The remitter may write a communication to the payee on the coupon portion of the money order form. This portion is detached and given to the payee at the time of payment.



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Financial Services Division (Notification No. FS-14/2024-MO)

eMO (Electronic Money Order) System:

- **Standardization:** All Inland Money Orders are now transmitted electronically (eMO).
- **Maximum Limit:** The maximum limit for a single eMO remains **Rs. 5,000**.
- **Instant Money Order (iMO):** Service available for amounts from **Rs. 1,000** to **Rs. 50,000** (Instant web-based transfer).

Rule 245. Alteration of Payee's Name or Address

(1) The remitter of a money order which has not been paid may require:

- That the address of the payee shall be altered.
- That the name of the payee shall be altered.
- That the money order shall be stopped and the money repaid to him.

(2) **No Fee Cases:** No additional fee is charged if:

- The alteration is only in the address of the payee (within India).
- The money is to be repaid to the remitter.

(3) **Fee Cases:** If the name of the payee is to be changed to that of *another person*, a **second commission** (equal to the first commission) must be paid by the remitter.

(4) **Procedure:** The remitter must apply in writing to the Postmaster of the office of issue and enclose the money order receipt.

Rule 268. Payment of Money Orders

(1) **Procedure:** Money orders are paid by the postman at the address of the payee.

(2) **Limit for Postman:**

- A postman is not permitted to take out for payment money orders exceeding an aggregate value of **Rs. 5,000** (or the limit fixed by the Circle Head) at one time.
- Single Money Order limit for cash payment: **Rs. 5,000**.

(3) **Identification:** The postman must satisfy himself as to the identity of the payee. If the payee is not known, he must be identified by a respectable person known to the postman.

(4) **Signature:** The payee must sign the money order and the acknowledgment in ink. Thumb impressions must be attested.

Rule 275. Unpaid Money Orders

(1) If the payee cannot be found, or if the payee refuses to take payment, the money order should be returned to the office of issue for repayment to the remitter.

(2) **Refusal:** If the payee refuses payment, the word "**Refused**" should be written across the money order.

Rule 276. Void Money Orders

(1) **Period of Currency:** A money order remains current for a period of **one month** following the month of issue.

(2) **Becoming Void:** If a money order is not paid to the payee or repaid to the remitter before the expiration of the **last day of the month following the month of issue**, it becomes a **Void Money Order**.

(3) **Revival:** A void money order cannot be paid without the special sanction of the **Head of the Circle** (or competent authority authorized by him).

(4) **Forfeiture:** If the claim for the amount of a void money order is not preferred within **one year** from the date of issue, the amount is forfeited to the Government.



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Note on Digital Payments:

While eMOs are digitally tracked, the statutory rule for "Void" status technically remains tied to the accounting cycle described above. However, in the Core Banking Solution (CBS) environment, unclaimed amounts are automatically classified as "Void MO" in the system after the prescribed period.

Rule 281. Loss of Money Order

(1) If a money order is lost in transit, a **Duplicate Money Order** may be issued.

(2) **Application:** The remitter or the payee may apply for an inquiry. If the money order has not been paid, a duplicate is issued **free of charge**.

(3) **Indemnity:** The Post Office is responsible for the amount of the money order if it is proved that the money order was lost or paid to the wrong person due to the negligence of the postal staff.

Chapter 10: Value Payable (V.P.) Articles

Rule 290. General Rules (V.P.)

(1) Registered parcels, registered letters, registered book packets, and newspapers with or without registration may be transmitted by the inland post as **Value Payable** articles.

(2) **Declaration:** The sender must declare the amount to be recovered from the addressee. This amount is termed the "Value Payable" amount.

(3) **Limit:** The amount specified for recovery from the addressee shall not exceed **Rs. 5,000**.



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Financial Services Division (Notification No. FS-COD-2025)

Cash on Delivery (COD) Facility:

For bulk customers (contractual), the "Value Payable" system is largely replaced by the COD (Cash on Delivery) facility linked to Speed Post/Business Parcel.

- **Maximum Limit (COD):** Rs. 50,000 per article.
- **Payment Mode:** Remittance to sender is done directly to the bank account via ECS/NEFT (Electronic Clearance Service), unlike the V.P. Money Order system.

Rule 296. Detention of V.P. Articles

(1) If the addressee of a value-payable article is not found, or if the article cannot be delivered for any other reason, an intimation (Form **Rp-53**) should be served.

(2) **Retention Period:** The article shall be retained in the post office for a period of **7 days** following the date of the first presentation or the date of delivery of the intimation.

(3) **Detention on Request:** If the addressee applies in writing for the detention of the article, it may be detained for a further period not exceeding **7 days** (Total **14 days**).

(4) **Demurrage Fee:** For this extra detention (from the 8th day to the 14th day), a fee termed "**Warehousing Charge**" (Demurrage) must be recovered from the addressee at the time of delivery.

**STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):****Post Office Guide, Part I (2025 Edition) - Clause 55****Warehousing Charges:**

- **Rate: Rs. 3.00** per day (for V.P. Letters/Packets).
 - **Rate: Rs. 5.00** per day (for V.P. Parcels).
 - **Exemption:** No charge is levied if the post office is closed or if the delay is due to the fault of the service.
-

Rule 298. Procedure when V.P. is Refused

(1) If the addressee refuses to accept a V.P. article or refuses to pay the amount due, the article must be returned to the sender **immediately**. It should not be detained.

(2) **Unclaimed:** If the addressee fails to take delivery after the expiry of the prescribed detention period (7 days or 14 days as applicable), the article is treated as **Unclaimed** and returned to the sender.

Chapter 11: Official Postal Articles

Rule 305. Official Postal Articles

- (1) Official postal articles must bear the superscription "**On India Government Service**" (O.I.G.S.) or "**On Service**" when posted by authorized government officials.
- (2) **Stamps:** They must bear **Service Postage Stamps** (overprinted "SERVICE"). Ordinary postage stamps should not be used on official correspondence unless service stamps are unavailable.
- (3) **Signature:** The official's signature and designation must be entered in the lower left-hand corner of the article (or on the frank).



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Department of Posts (Philately Division) Instruction 2024-25

Restriction on Service Stamps:

- Service stamps are strictly for the use of **Government Offices** only.
- **Use by Public:** Possession or use of Service Stamps by private individuals or unauthorized bodies is **prohibited** and punishable under the Indian Post Office Act.
- **Phase Out:** Government departments are being encouraged to migrate to **Franking Machines** or **Pre-payment Accounts** to reduce the printing of physical Service stamps.

Rule 309. Unpaid Official Articles

- (1) Official articles which are **unpaid** or **insufficiently paid** are not taxed with the usual double deficiency penalty.
- (2) **Charge:** They are charged with the **single deficiency** (actual amount due) only.
- (3) **Prepayment:** The rule requiring prepayment of postage on parcels does not apply strictly to official parcels; however, the postage should generally be prepaid.

Rule 312. Camp Articles

- (1) Articles addressed to officers of the Government "in Camp" (e.g., "**Camp Bag**") are delivered without claim for any redirection fee, provided the officer is entitled to the privilege.

(2) **Privilege:** This privilege is restricted to high-ranking officers (e.g., President, Prime Minister, Director-General of Posts) mentioned in the "Camp List" issued by the Director-General.

(3) **Camp Bags:** Special bags containing official mail for such officers are termed "**Camp Bags**".



Chapter 12: Identification Cards

Rule 317. System of Identification Cards

- (1) The system of **Identification Cards** is intended to enable strangers to establish their identity when applying for the delivery of registered or insured articles or for the payment of money orders.
- (2) **Application:** Any respectable person who is literate and can sign his name may apply to the Head Postmaster for an identification card.
- (3) **Fee:** The application must be accompanied by a fee of **Rs. 9** (historic/manual rate) and a photograph of the applicant of the passport size.



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Department of Posts (PO Division) Notification

Current Fee Structure:

- The fee for the issue of an Identification Card is currently **Rs. 100** (subject to periodic revision).
- The card is valid for a period of **3 years** from the date of issue.
- ***Note: With the implementation of Aadhaar-based biometric authentication for many postal services, the physical Identification Card system is less frequently used but remains a valid statutory provision.***

Rule 319. Particulars of the Card

- (1) The card will contain a full description of the holder, his signature, and his photograph.
- (2) **Validity:** The card will be valid for a period of **3 years** from the date of issue.
- (3) **Use:** When the holder applies for a postal transaction, he must produce the card. The postal official will compare the signature and photograph on the card with the person and the signature on the

Chapter 13: Franking Machines

Rule 322. Licensing of Franking Machines

- (1) The Director-General may authorize the use of franking machines by government offices, commercial firms, and private individuals for the prepayment of postage.
- (2) **License:** No machine may be used without a **License** issued by the **Head of the Postal Division** (Superintendent of Post Offices).
- (3) **Conditions:** The machine must be of a type and pattern approved by the Director-General.



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Technology Division (Notification No. Tech-FM/2025-RMFM)

Mandatory Migration to RMFM:

- All Electronic Franking Machines (EFMs) with older technology have been phased out.
- Only **Remotely Managed Franking Machines (RMFM)** (Digi-Frinking) are permitted for new licenses and renewals.
- **RMFM Features:** These machines download funds remotely via a secure server (Credifon) and do not require physical travel to the Post Office for resetting.

Rule 324. Conditions of Use

- (1) **Impressions:** The franking machine impression must be **bright red** in color.
 - It must show the value of postage, the name of the office of posting, and the date.
- (2) **Slogan:** The user may print a slogan or advertisement alongside the frank impression, provided the design has been approved by the Licensing Authority.
- (3) **Daily Docket:** The user must maintain a "Daily Docket" or usage register showing the meter readings before and after use each day.

Rule 328. Posting of Franked Articles

- (1) Franked articles must be tendered at the counter of the specific post office designated in the license.

(2) **Sorting:** The articles must be bundled according to the value of the frank (e.g., all **Rs. 5** articles in one bundle).

(3) **Limit:** There is no limit to the number of articles that can be posted, but they must be presented within the business hours fixed for the purpose.

(4) **Letter Boxes:** Franked articles must **not** be posted in letter boxes. If found in a letter box, they will be treated as **unpaid** articles.

Rule 329. Rebate on Franking Machine Usage

(1) A rebate is granted to the user of a franking machine on the total value of postage used.

(2) **Condition:** The rebate is calculated on the postage consumed during the previous month.



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Postal Operations Division (Rebate Structure 2025)

Rebate for RMFM Users:

Minimum Consumption	Rebate Rate
Up to Rs. 5,000	Nil
Rs. 5,001 and above	3% on the entire amount.

- **Condition:** The articles must be sorted Pin-code wise (or as per Sorting District) and bundled correctly.
- **Payment:** The rebate is credited to the franking machine account at the time of the next resetting/upload.

Rule 330. Resetting of the Machine

(1) **Manual/Electronic Machines:** The machine must be brought to the post office for resetting (loading of funds) when the credit is exhausted.

(2) **Procedure:** The window clerk checks the meter readings, collects the payment, and resets the meter in the presence of the user.

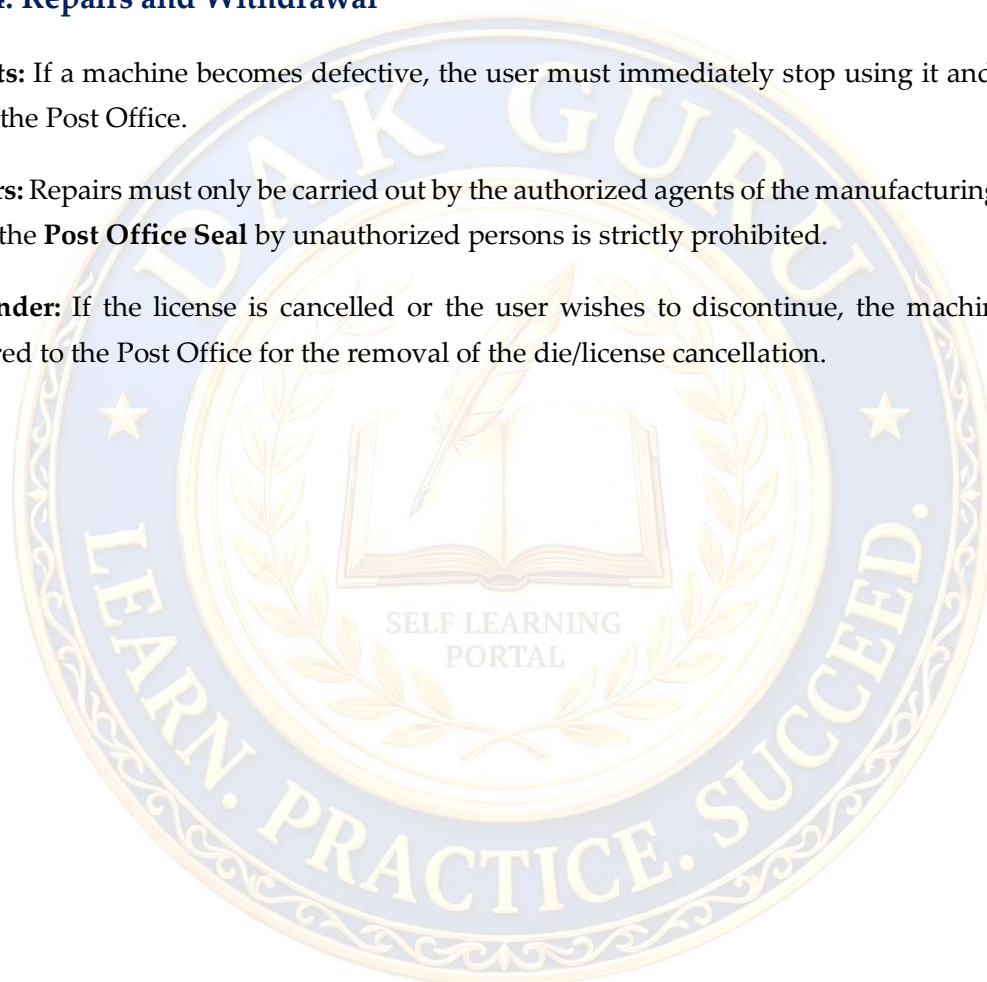
(3) **RMFM (2025):** For Remotely Managed Franking Machines, the physical movement of the machine is **not required**. The user deposits money in the designated bank/post office account, and the credit is downloaded via the modem/internet connection.

Rule 334. Repairs and Withdrawal

(1) **Defects:** If a machine becomes defective, the user must immediately stop using it and report the matter to the Post Office.

(2) **Repairs:** Repairs must only be carried out by the authorized agents of the manufacturing company. Breaking the **Post Office Seal** by unauthorized persons is strictly prohibited.

(3) **Surrender:** If the license is cancelled or the user wishes to discontinue, the machine must be surrendered to the Post Office for the removal of the die/license cancellation.



Chapter 14: Post Office Savings Bank (Administrative Rules)

Rule 340. General Responsibility

(1) The Postmaster is responsible for the correct maintenance of the Savings Bank accounts and for the safe custody of the passbooks and other documents connected with them.

(2) **Secrecy:** The officers of the Postal Department are prohibited from disclosing the name of any depositor or the amount deposited or withdrawn, except to the depositor himself or to officers of the Department who are concerned with the Savings Bank work.

(3) **Exception:** Information may be disclosed to:

- A Court of Law.
- Income Tax Authorities (under specific statutory provisions).



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

Government Savings Promotion General Rules, 2018 (Amended 2024)

Rule 13. Secrecy:

While secrecy is maintained, the Post Office is now mandated to share data with:

- **Financial Intelligence Unit (FIU-IND)** for high-value transactions (AML/CFT compliance).
- **Income Tax Department** (SFT - Statement of Financial Transactions) for cash deposits exceeding **Rs. 10 Lakhs** in a financial year.

Rule 343. Application for Opening Account

(1) Any person wishing to open an account must fill up an application form (Form **SB-3**).

(2) **Introduction:** The applicant must be introduced by a respectable person known to the Postmaster or by a depositor who has an account in the same post office.

(3) **KYC:** The Postmaster must ensure that the address and identity of the depositor are verified.



STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):

SB Order No. 05/2025 (KYC Master Circular)

Mandatory Documents:

- **Aadhaar Number** and **PAN (Permanent Account Number)** are mandatory for opening any new account.
- If PAN is not submitted at the time of opening, it must be submitted within **6 months**, failing which the account shall be frozen.
- **Photograph:** Recent photograph is mandatory for all depositors.

Rule 345. Passbooks

(1) A passbook (Form **SB-5**) is supplied to every depositor free of charge at the time of opening the account.

(2) **Presentation:** The passbook must be presented at the time of every deposit or withdrawal.

(3) **Custody:** The passbook should remain in the custody of the depositor. It should not be kept in the Post Office except when it is required for the entry of interest or for examination by the Inspecting Officer.

**STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):**

Core Banking Solution (CBS) Procedure:

- **System Generated Passbooks:** Manual entries in passbooks are discontinued in CBS offices. All entries must be printed using the Passbook Printer.
- **Non-Home Branch:** A depositor can present the passbook at **any** CBS Post Office in India for deposit/withdrawal (subject to limits).

Rule 350. Deposits and Withdrawals

(1) **Minimum Deposit:** The minimum amount of first deposit is **Rs. 500** (for ordinary Savings Account).

(2) **Cheques:** Deposits may be made by cheque. The credit will be given only on the date of realization of the cheque.

(3) **Withdrawal Form:** The depositor must present the passbook and a withdrawal form (Form **SB-7**) signed by him.

**STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):**

Revised Transaction Limits (SB Order 2025):

Transaction Type	Limit (2025)
Minimum Balance	Rs. 500 (Maintenance fee of Rs. 100 deducted if non-compliant).
Maximum Balance	No limit for Single/Joint accounts.
Cash Withdrawal	Up to Rs. 20,000 without supervisory sanction (Counter PA limit).
Daily Limit	ATM Withdrawal: Rs. 25,000 per day.

Rule 365. Silent Accounts

(1) An account in which no deposit or withdrawal has taken place for a period of **three complete financial years** is treated as a "Silent Account."

(2) **Revival:** No transaction will be allowed in a silent account until it is revived by the Postmaster after obtaining a fresh application and KYC documents from the depositor.

**STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):**

Terminology Change: "Silent Accounts" are now officially termed "Inoperative Accounts".

- **Period:** 3 Years of inactivity.
- **Interest:** Interest continues to be credited to Inoperative Accounts (unlike earlier rules where it stopped).

Rule 370. Settlement of Deceased Claims

(1) If a depositor dies, the amount standing to his credit may be paid to his nominee or legal heir.

(2) **Nomination:** If a valid nomination exists (registered in the Post Office records), the amount shall be paid to the nominee.

(3) **Without Nomination:** If there is no nomination, claims up to a certain limit may be settled by the competent authority (Postmaster/Superintendent) on the basis of a claim form and indemnity bond.

**STATUTORY UPDATE (2025):**

Sanction Limits for Deceased Claims (SB Order 2024-25):

Authority	Limit (No Nomination Cases)
Sub-Postmaster	Up to Rs. 50,000
Head Postmaster	Up to Rs. 5,00,000
Superintendent	Up to Rs. 10,00,000
Regional/Circle Head	Above Rs. 10,00,000

- Note: For claims with Nomination, the Postmaster of the office where the account stands can settle the claim irrespective of the amount.*

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